

PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

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Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

1. Introduction

The Project Planning Phase defines the activities, resources, workflow, responsibilities, and sequence required to implement the automated **Standard Laptop procurement process** in ServiceNow.

The project is planned around the creation of a Flow Designer workflow, assignment of the flow to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item, and testing of the request and approval process. The overall aim is to reduce manual intervention, improve task allocation, and ensure timely laptop configuration.

2. Project Goal

The main goal of the project is to automate the Standard Laptop procurement process using **ServiceNow Flow Designer**.

The planned automation will:

- Allow users to request a Standard Laptop.
- Process the request through approval.
- Automatically create a Catalog Task.
- Automatically assign the task to the Hardware group.
- Provide the required task description.
- Allow the resulting task to be verified through the Requested Item record.

The project user story specifically requires tasks to be automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration.

3. Project Scope

In Scope

The project includes:

1. Creating the Standard Laptop Flow.
2. Configuring the Service Catalog trigger.
3. Creating the Catalog Task action.
4. Configuring the task description.

5. Assigning the task to the Hardware group.
6. Assigning the flow to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.
7. Placing a Standard Laptop request.
8. Processing the approval.
9. Checking the generated Catalog Task.
10. Verifying the task status, description, and assignment group.

The PDF organizes the implementation into three milestones: **Flow, Flow Assignment, and Service Catalog.**

Out of Scope

The provided project document does not specify additional procurement activities such as vendor selection, purchasing payment, inventory management, physical delivery tracking, or asset disposal. Therefore, these activities are not included in the planned project scope.

4. Project Milestones

The project is divided into three main milestones.

Milestone	Main Activity	Expected Output
Milestone 1	Flow Creation	Standard Laptop Task Flow
Milestone 2	Flow Assignment	Flow connected to Standard Laptop Catalog Item
Milestone 3	Service Catalog	Laptop request, approval and task verification

The three milestones correspond to the implementation structure provided in the project document.

5. Activity Planning

Milestone 1 – Flow Creation

Activity: Create the Standard Laptop Task Flow.

Planned activities:

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Open Flow Designer.
3. Create a new Flow.
4. Name the flow **Standard Laptop Task**.

5. Set the application to **Global**.
6. Select **System User** as the Run As user.
7. Add the **Service Catalog** trigger.
8. Add the **Create Catalog Task** action.
9. Use the Requested Item Record.
10. Configure the Catalog Task fields.
11. Save the flow.
12. Activate the flow.

These activities follow the flow creation procedure documented in the PDF.

Milestone 2 – Flow Assignment

Activity: Assign the Standard Laptop Task flow to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.

Planned activities:

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Search for **Maintain Items**.
3. Locate **Standard Laptop**.
4. Open the Process Engine configuration.
5. Remove the remaining automation as specified.
6. Add the **Standard Laptop Task** flow.
7. Save the configuration.

The purpose is to connect the newly created automation with the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.

Milestone 3 – Service Catalog

Activity: Place a Standard Laptop order and verify the automated workflow.

Planned activities:

1. Open Service Catalog.
2. Open the Hardware category.
3. Select Standard Laptop.

4. Select **Order Now**.
5. View the order status.
6. Open the Request Number.
7. Check the Approvers section.
8. Approve the request.
9. Open the Requested Item.
10. Open the Catalog Tasks section.
11. Check the generated task.
12. Verify the short description and assignment group.

These activities follow the Service Catalog and verification procedure in the project document.

6. Resource Planning

Software Resources

The project requires:

- ServiceNow platform
- Flow Designer
- Service Catalog
- Maintain Items
- Standard Laptop Catalog Item
- Catalog Task functionality

Human Resources

The project involves the following functional roles:

Role	Responsibility
User/Requester	Places Standard Laptop request
Approver	Reviews and approves the request
IT Procurement Team	Manages and monitors the procurement workflow
Hardware Team	Receives and processes the laptop configuration task
System Administrator	Configures ServiceNow Flow Designer and Service Catalog

The user story identifies the IT procurement team and Hardware team as key participants in the automated process.

7. Task Allocation Plan

The project tasks can be organized as follows:

Task	Responsible Role
Create Flow	System Administrator
Configure Trigger	System Administrator
Configure Catalog Task	System Administrator
Assign Hardware Group	System Administrator
Assign Flow to Standard Laptop	System Administrator
Place Laptop Request	User/Requester
Approve Request	Approver
Verify Catalog Task	IT Procurement Team
Configure Laptop	Hardware Team

8. Workflow Planning

The planned workflow is:

```
User
↓
Service Catalog
↓
Standard Laptop
↓
Order Now
↓
Request
↓
Approval
↓
Standard Laptop Task Flow
↓
Create Catalog Task
↓
Assign to Hardware
↓
Laptop Configuration
↓
Task Verification
```

The project specifically intends to automatically generate and assign the configuration task after the request process, reducing manual intervention.

9. Configuration Planning

The Catalog Task will be planned with the following configuration:

Configuration	Planned Value
Flow Name	Standard Laptop Task
Application	Global
Run As	System User
Trigger	Service Catalog
Action	Create Catalog Task
Request Item	Requested Item Record
Short Description	Laptop need to Configured
Description	Laptop need to Configured
Assignment Group	Hardware
Approval	Approved

These values are directly based on the documented Flow Designer configuration.

10. Testing Plan

Testing will verify that the complete workflow operates as intended.

Test 1 – Service Catalog Access

Expected Result:

The Standard Laptop item is available under the Hardware category.

Test 2 – Request Creation

Expected Result:

Selecting Order Now creates the Standard Laptop request.

Test 3 – Approval

Expected Result:

The request can be accessed through the Request Number and its approval section.

Test 4 – Flow Execution

Expected Result:

The configured Standard Laptop Task flow processes the request.

Test 5 – Catalog Task Creation

Expected Result:

A Catalog Task is automatically created.

Test 6 – Task Description

Expected Result:

The task contains the description “**Laptop need to Configured.**”

Test 7 – Assignment

Expected Result:

The Catalog Task is assigned to the **Hardware** group.

Test 8 – Task Verification

Expected Result:

The generated task can be viewed from the Requested Item's Catalog Tasks section, with the expected short description and assignment group.

11. Risk Planning

Potential Risk	Planned Mitigation
Flow is not activated	Save and activate the flow before testing
Incorrect trigger configuration	Verify Service Catalog trigger
Catalog Task not created	Check Create Catalog Task action
Wrong assignment group	Verify Hardware assignment group
Incorrect task description	Check the configured short description and description
Flow not connected to catalog item	Verify Process Engine configuration
Request not processed	Check approval status and request record
The PDF explicitly includes saving and activating the flow and assigning it to the Standard Laptop catalog item, making these important planning activities.	

12. Project Deliverables

The planned project deliverables are:

1. **Standard Laptop Task Flow**
2. **Configured Service Catalog Trigger**
3. **Configured Create Catalog Task Action**
4. **Hardware assignment configuration**
5. **Standard Laptop Catalog Item integration**
6. **Working Standard Laptop request process**
7. **Approval workflow**

8. Automatically generated Catalog Task
 9. Task verification results
 10. Final project documentation
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13. Expected Project Outcome

At the completion of the project, an approved Standard Laptop request should result in an automatically generated Catalog Task assigned to the Hardware team for laptop configuration.

The planned automation is intended to reduce manual overhead, minimize user waiting time, improve resource allocation, and enhance productivity in the IT procurement process.

14. Planning Phase Conclusion

The Project Planning Phase establishes a structured implementation plan consisting of **Flow Creation, Flow Assignment, and Service Catalog processing**. Each milestone has defined activities, resources, responsibilities, testing requirements, and expected outputs.

This plan provides the foundation for implementing and validating the automated Standard Laptop procurement workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer.